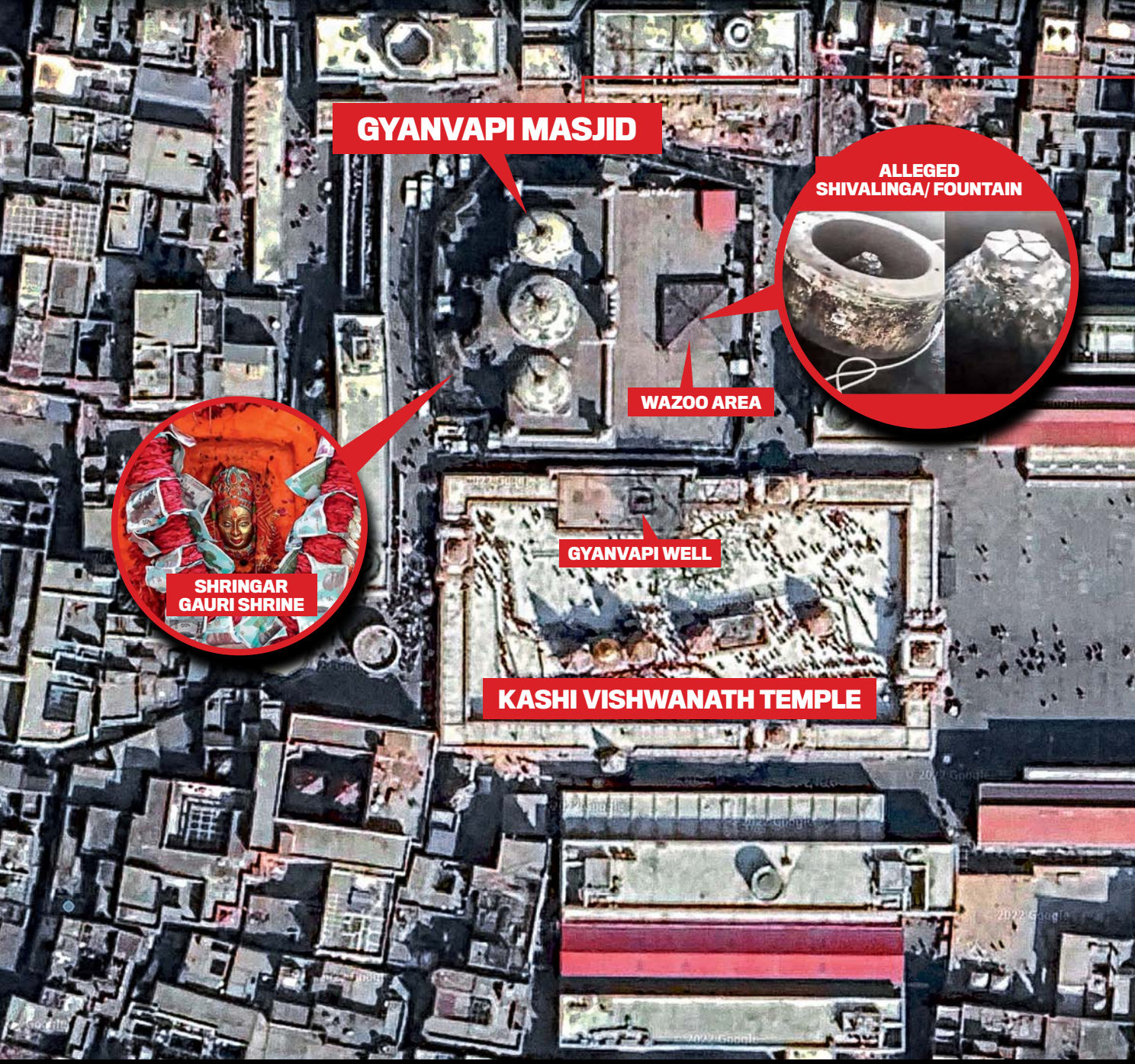


CONTESTED PRAYERS

In 1937, the Allahabad High Court in the Deen Mohammad vs. State Secretary case decreed that while the Gyanvapi complex would be treated as a Waqf property, the Hindu Vyas family would be in possession of the masjid's basement and cellars.

The Narasimha Rao government passed the Places of Worship (Special Provisions) Act **in 1991**, at the peak of the Ram Janmabhoomi movement. The law mandated that with Babri Masjid in Ayodhya as the only exception, the religious character of all other places of worship would be maintained as it was on August 15, 1947.

On October 15, 1991, Pt. Somnath Vyas, Dr Ramrang Sharma and a few others filed a suit in a Varanasi court, demanding the construction of a new temple in Gyanvapi complex and permission to worship there. The district judge ordered the case to be heard, but on August 13, 1998, the Allahabad High Court stayed this decision.

After the death of Somnath Vyas in **March 2000,** the court named advocate Vijay Shankar Rastogi as the litigant in Oct. 2018. Rastogi then appealed to a civil judge to conduct a radar technical survey of the Gyanvapi complex. After the appeal was allowed, Gyanvapi authorities filed a petition in the HC against the order. The case is ongoing.